Lo-Fi Sample Chop

Sounds like: dusty chopped-soul loop — J Dilla / Madlib texture

ACCURACY B

Close enough to fool most ears.

NOT YET TESTED - settings are a starting point; trust your ears

WHAT YOU NEED (in this order)

`NN-XT (chops) -> MClass EQ (bandwidth cut) -> Scream 4 (tape) -> CF-101 (subtle warble)`

Starting material: any clean melodic sample or your own recorded chords

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DO THIS, STEP BY STEP

1. Chop: load the sample into NN-XT, slice your chops across pads/keys (or use Dr. Octo Rex if it's a REX loop). Root each chop to a comfortable key zone.

2. Play the chops as an instrument — the flip matters more than the effects. Get the pattern right before any processing.

3. MClass EQ: Lo Cut ON, plus high cut — Param 2 at ~9 kHz, -9 dB, wide Q. Old records have no extreme top or bottom; this single move is 50% of "lo-fi."

4. Scream 4: Damage type Tape, Damage 30–45, P2 (speed) low. Compression-like thickening plus soft-clip warmth.

5. Vinyl layer: put an actual vinyl-crackle sample (free online) on its own channel under the loop at -25 dB. Fake crackle from a device fools nobody; a real crackle recording does.

6. Warble: CF-101, rate very slow (~15), delay ~50, feedback 0, sync OFF, dry/wet low. This fakes tape pitch drift. Subtle — if you can point to it, halve it.

7. Bus it with your boom-bap drum bus recipe; shared Scream on the 2-bus marries loop and drums.

Why this works

Removing highs/lows and adding harmonic clutter mimics generational loss — the ear reads "old media" as "warm and nostalgic."

Why this order

EQ before saturation: cutting the top first means Scream's harmonics land in the mids where the warmth lives, not as brittle top.

Reason trick

NN-XT group feature: set chop groups to mono/legato so overlapping chops cut each other off like an MPC in mono mode.

The skill you just learned
Bandwidth reduction as a vibe tool — and layering real-world noise instead of synthesizing it.

Worth buying?
None required. If chopping is your main workflow, the Beat Map or similar chop-focused RE speeds the workflow but doesn't change the sound.